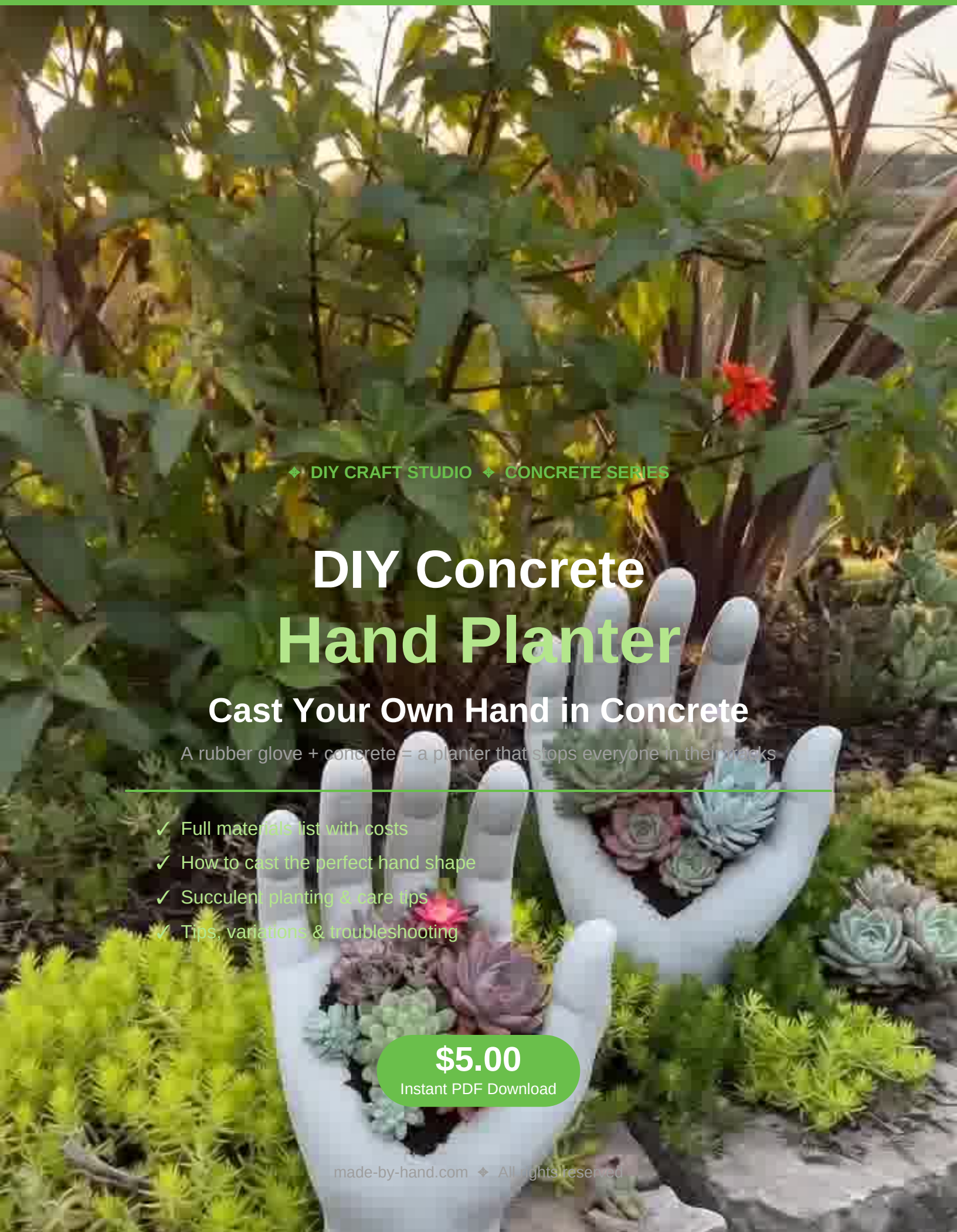

✦ DIY CRAFT STUDIO ✦ CONCRETE SERIES

DIY Concrete Hand Planter

Cast Your Own Hand in Concrete

A rubber glove + concrete = a planter that stops everyone in their tracks

- ✓ Full materials list with costs
- ✓ How to cast the perfect hand shape
- ✓ Succulent planting & care tips
- ✓ Tips, variations & troubleshooting

$5.00
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Materials & What You'll Need

About This Project

This jaw-dropping planter is made by filling a rubber glove with wet concrete, shaping it into an open-hand position, and letting it cure. Once the glove peels away, you have a perfect concrete hand ready to hold succulents, air plants, or moss. Total cost: $15–35. Difficulty: Beginner. Each hand takes about 20 minutes to set up, then 48 hours to cure.

MATERIALS LIST

ITEM	QUANTITY	COST (EST.)
Quikrete or similar concrete mix (fast-set)	1 bag (50 lb)	**$8–12**
Large rubber/latex gloves (size L or XL)	2–4 gloves	**$5–8**
Black nitrile inner gloves (for texture)	Same number as outer	**$4–6**
Plastic bucket (5-gallon)	1	**Own/borrow**
Mixing stick or trowel	1	**$3–5**
Small funnel or spoon (for filling glove)	1	**$1–2**
Sand or gravel (hand support while curing)	Small bag	**$3–5**
Acrylic sealer (optional, weatherproofing)	1 small can	**$8–12**
Succulents or air plants	3–6 per hand	**$10–20**
Potting mix (succulent/cactus blend)	Small bag	**$5–8**
ESTIMATED TOTAL		**$15 – $35 (+ plants)**

PRO TIP:

Use TWO gloves — a thin nitrile inner glove for texture detail, then a thicker rubber outer glove over it. The inner glove captures every knuckle and skin line in the concrete, making the finished hand look shockingly realistic. The outer glove holds the shape while it cures.

Step-by-Step Instructions

01 Mix the Concrete

Mix concrete to a thick, smooth consistency — like thick yogurt or peanut butter. Too watery and it won't hold shape; too thick and it won't fill the glove fingers. Add water slowly. Wear your nitrile gloves while mixing.

02 Fill the Glove

Put on the thin nitrile glove first, then pull the rubber glove over it. Use a spoon or funnel to fill concrete into each finger first, then fill the palm. Tap the glove gently on a table to remove air pockets. Fill to about 1 inch below the wrist.

03 Shape & Position

Shape the hand into an open, cupped position — fingers spread, palm slightly curved upward to hold plants. Prop it in a tray of sand or gravel to hold the position. Make sure the palm faces up and the wrist end is sealed with a twist-tie.

04 Press Hand & Cure

Press the gloved hand firmly onto the surface to flatten the palm base slightly (so it can stand). Cover loosely with plastic and leave in a cool, shaded area for 48 hours minimum. Do not move or touch during curing — patience is key!

05 Peel, Plant & Display

Carefully peel away both gloves — the hand should be solid and detailed. Sand any rough edges lightly. Seal with acrylic if using outdoors. Add succulent mix, then plant your succulents. Display on a wall, step, or stone border. ■

Tips, Variations & Troubleshooting

✦ PRO TIPS FOR BEST RESULTS

■ **Double glove always:** The inner nitrile layer captures skin-like texture. Skip it and the hand looks smooth and fake.

■ **Thick mix only:** Watery concrete slumps and loses finger shape. It should hold a peak when you lift the spoon.

■■ **Sand support:** A box of sand lets you press the hand into any pose and holds it perfectly during the cure.

■ **Drainage hole:** Before the concrete fully sets (at ~24h), poke a small hole in the palm base with a skewer.

■■ **Seal for outdoors:** One coat of clear acrylic sealer makes it frost-resistant and prevents surface crumbling.

✦ CREATIVE VARIATIONS

- Make a pair of hands — one slightly smaller (child's hand) for a touching display
- Add pigment powder to the concrete mix for colored hands — terracotta, charcoal, or white
- Plant with moss instead of succulents for a woodland, fairy-garden look
- Pose fingers in a peace sign, pointing up, or curled around a small candle holder
- Make a foot planter using the same technique with a rubber boot or sock mold
- Mount on a wooden fence post for a dramatic vertical garden display

✦ TROUBLESHOOTING

Q: Fingers collapsed or lost shape
A: Mix was too wet. Next time add less water and fill fingers first before the palm.

Q: Glove stuck and won't peel off
A: It needs more curing time. Leave another 24 hours before trying again — never force it.

Q: Surface is crumbly or weak
A: Concrete dried too fast. Keep covered and misted. Also check you used enough cement in the mix.

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